Fulbright at 80

Eight Decades of Building Mutual Understanding Through Educational Exchange



Since 1946, the Fulbright Program has connected people, ideas, and cultures across the globe, creating a lasting legacy of international cooperation and leadership. Fulbright Canada joined the global Fulbright Program in 1990, sharing its values and commitment to the mission.

Fulbright at 80

80 YEARS OF GLOBAL IMPACT

The Fulbright Program was established on August 1, 1946, when President Harry S. Truman signed the Fulbright Act into law. Built on a vision of promoting international goodwill and mutual understanding through educational exchange, the program has connected students, scholars, educators, and professionals around the world for nearly eight decades.

As Fulbright celebrates its 80th anniversary, we reflect on the lasting impact of these exchanges and the countless partnerships, discoveries, and friendships they have helped foster.



160+
PARTICIPATING COUNTRIES

450K+
FULBRIGHT ALUMNI WORLDWIDE

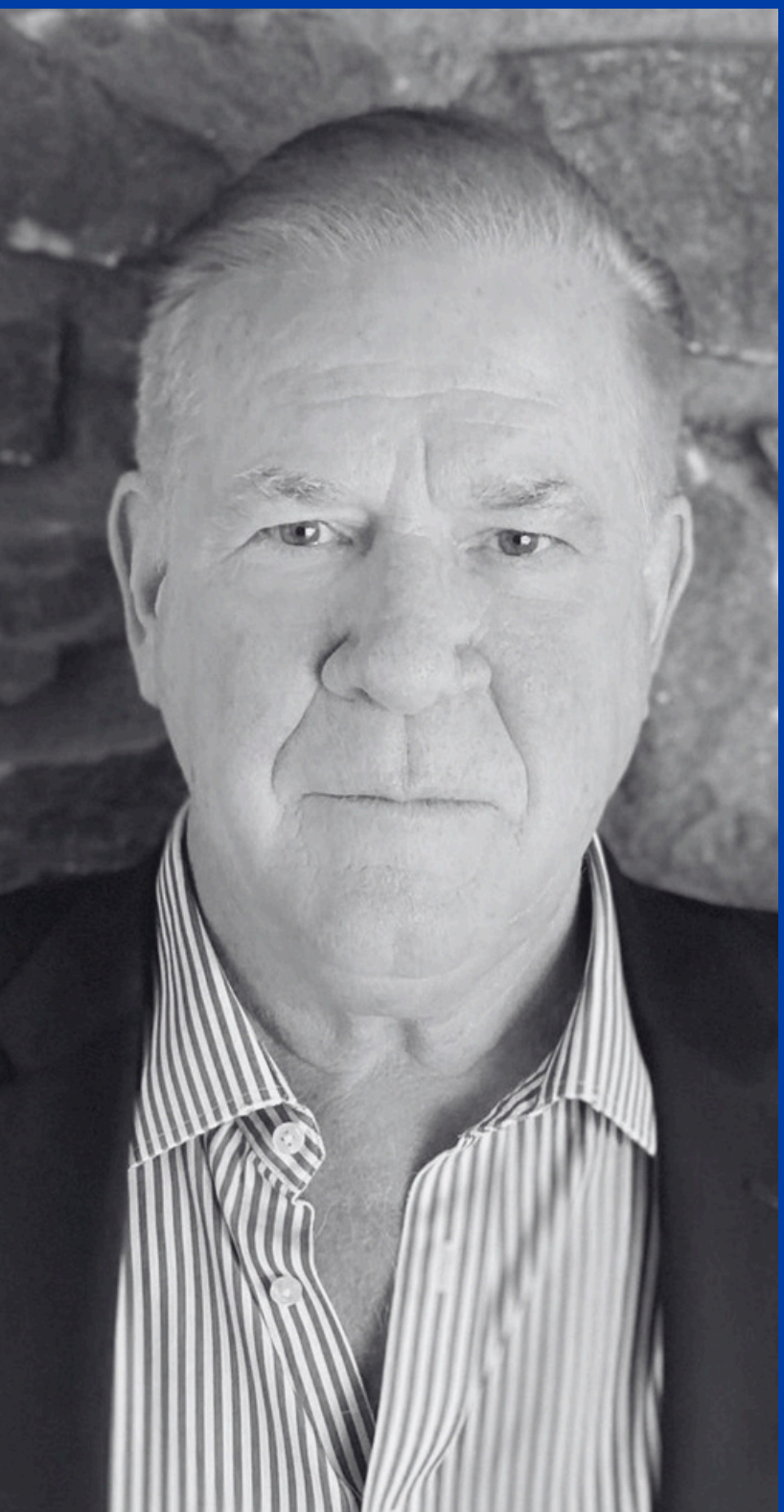
64
NOBEL LAUREATES

94
PULITZER PRIZE WINNERS

83
MACARTHUR GENIUS FELLOWSHIPS

51
NATIONAL BOOK AWARDS

A MESSAGE FROM
FULBRIGHT CANADA'S CEO



For eight decades, Fulbright has shown what is possible when people are given the opportunity to learn from one another across borders. The story told in these pages reflects more than milestones and numbers, it reflects lives shaped, ideas exchanged, and relationships built through trust and shared purpose.

At its heart, Fulbright is about the belief that knowledge grows through connection, and that understanding across cultures is built through sustained dialogue and collaboration.

As we mark this 80th anniversary, we also look ahead with clarity of purpose. The need for thoughtful exchange and global cooperation remains as urgent as ever, and Fulbright will continue to support those who are willing to listen, learn, and lead together.

The legacy we celebrate today is also the foundation for what comes next.

Michael Hawes

Dr. Michael K. Hawes
President & CEO of Fulbright Canada
1999-2000 Fulbright Scholar

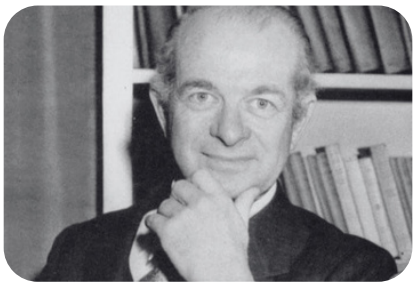
Fulbright at 80

1946-2026



1946 The Fulbright Program is Established

To promote international goodwill and mutual understanding, President Harry S. Truman signed the Fulbright Act into law on August 1, 1946, launching the framework for the Fulbright Program.



1954 Year of Seven Fulbright Nobel Prize Laureates

Future Fulbrighter Linus Pauling won the 1954 Nobel Prize in Chemistry, alongside six future Nobel Laureates who received Fulbright awards that year.



1954 John Hope Franklin Began Fulbright Journey

Franklin, a Presidential Medal of Freedom winner, author, historian, and Fulbright Foreign Scholarship Board Chair, went on his first Fulbright to the UK in 1954.



1958 First Fulbrighter on Record with a Disability

Jeff Davis Duty, Jr. began his Fulbright at the London School of Economics and later argued before the U.S. Supreme Court to allow guide dogs.



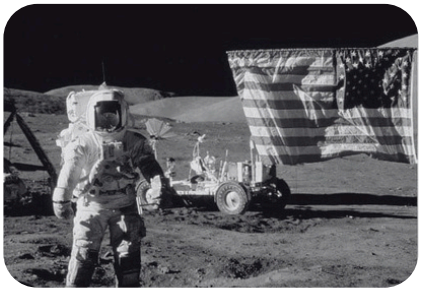
1961 Passage of the Fulbright-Hays Act

President John F. Kennedy signed the Fulbright-Hays Act, re-authorizing the program and enabling foreign government contributions.



1965 Future Nobel Laureate Began Fulbright

Muhammad Yunus came to the U.S. from Bangladesh to study economics and later won the 2006 Nobel Peace Prize for pioneering microlending through Grameen Bank.



1972 Fulbrighter Walked on the Moon

Apollo 17 astronaut and 1958 Fulbrighter Harrison “Jack” Schmitt is the only scientist to have walked on the Moon.



1978 Humphrey Fellowship Established

President Jimmy Carter created the Humphrey Fellowship Program, bringing global professionals to the U.S. for leadership development.



1986 Fulbright 40th Anniversary

Distinguished Lecturer Grants celebrated Fulbright’s anniversary, with recipients including Maya Angelou, who travelled to Liberia on her Fulbright in 1986.

Fulbright at 80

1946-2026



1990 Fulbright Canada Established

Canada joined the Fulbright Program in 1990, strengthening Canada–U.S. academic exchange and collaboration.



1992 Fulbright Expanded Following Cold War

Fulbright has been active in Eastern Europe since the 1940s, expanding across the region after the Cold War.



1993 Fulbright Association Prize Launched

The Fulbright Association awarded its first Fulbright Prize to Nelson Mandela for fighting apartheid.



1993 Rita Dove Named Poet Laureate

Rita Dove, a Fulbright alumna, became the first African American U.S. Poet Laureate and won a Pulitzer Prize.



2007 Fulbright Alumni Served in Congress

Fulbright alumni have served in Congress, including four elected to the U.S. House in 2007.



2011 Fulbright-Fogarty Fellowships Established

Fulbright-Fogarty Fellowships launched with the NIH to advance clinical research in resource-limited settings.



2014 National Geographic Fellowship Established

Fulbright partners with National Geographic to train Fulbrighters and spark global conversations.



2017 Teacher Exchanges Expanded

Teacher Exchanges connect 11,000+ educators worldwide through global learning experiences.



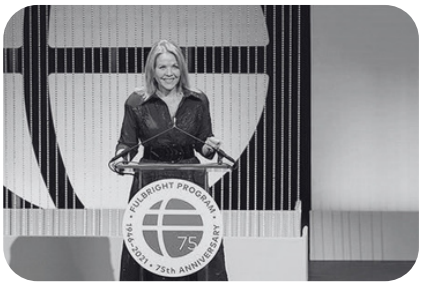
2019 Fulbright Brand Identity Refreshed

The refreshed brand highlights Fulbright's global community of changemakers.



2020 Six Fulbright Alumni Led Their Countries

Fulbright alumni have led nations including Belize, Afghanistan, Croatia, Guyana, Belgium, and Peru.



2021 75th Anniversary of the Fulbright Program

Fulbright celebrated 75 years of global impact and community connections.



2025 Entrepreneurship Initiative Launched

The Fulbright Canada Entrepreneurship Initiative was launched to support innovators and entrepreneurs through global exchange.

Fulbright at 80

FACES OF FULBRIGHT

★ AMERICAN



Dr. Christopher Sands is a faculty member at SAIS and a leading expert on U.S.-Canada relations. He has held senior positions at CSIS and the Hudson Institute, where he focused on North American trade, competitiveness, and border security.

CHRISTOPHER SANDS
FULBRIGHT STUDENT
1999-2000



Acacia Johnson is an Alaska-based photographer known for her work in the polar regions. Her photography has been featured in National Geographic and is held in the permanent collections of the Smithsonian Institution and the Anchorage Museum.

ACACIA JOHNSON
FULBRIGHT STUDENT
2014-2015



Dr. Gil Alterovitz is Chief AI Officer for the U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs and Director of the VA National Artificial Intelligence Institute. A faculty member at Harvard Medical School, he has helped shape U.S. AI strategy and is a two-time Fulbright Scholar to Canada and the United Kingdom.

GIL ALTEROVITZ
FULBRIGHT STUDENT
1998-1999

Fulbright at 80

FACES OF FULBRIGHT

CANADIAN



Mark Wiseman is Canada's Ambassador to the United States and a distinguished business leader and investor. He has held senior leadership roles at BlackRock, the Canada Pension Plan Investment Board, and the Alberta Investment Management Corporation, and is widely recognized for his expertise in institutional investing and pension fund management.

MARK WISEMAN
FULBRIGHT STUDENT
1997-1998



The **Honourable Anita Anand** is Canada's Minister of Foreign Affairs and a leading scholar in law and governance. A former Fulbright Scholar at Yale Law School, she has held several senior cabinet portfolios, including National Defence.

HON. ANITA ANAND
FULBRIGHT SCHOLAR
2005-2006

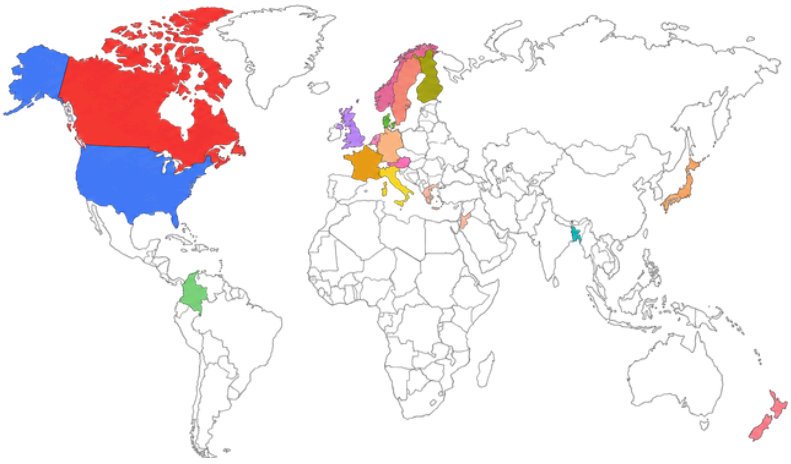


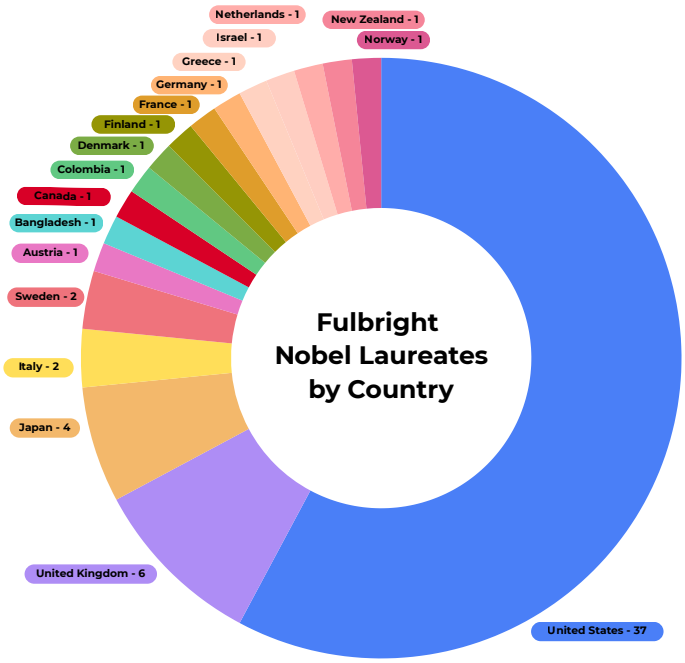
Kevin Brosseau serves as Commissioner of the Canadian Coast Guard, Senior Associate Deputy Minister of National Defence, and Canada's Fentanyl Czar. A veteran public servant and national security leader, he has held senior roles across government, including Deputy National Security and Intelligence Advisor to the Prime Minister.

KEVIN BROSSEAU
FULBRIGHT STUDENT
2002-2003

Fulbright at 80

Fulbright Nobel Laureates





64
Nobel Laureates

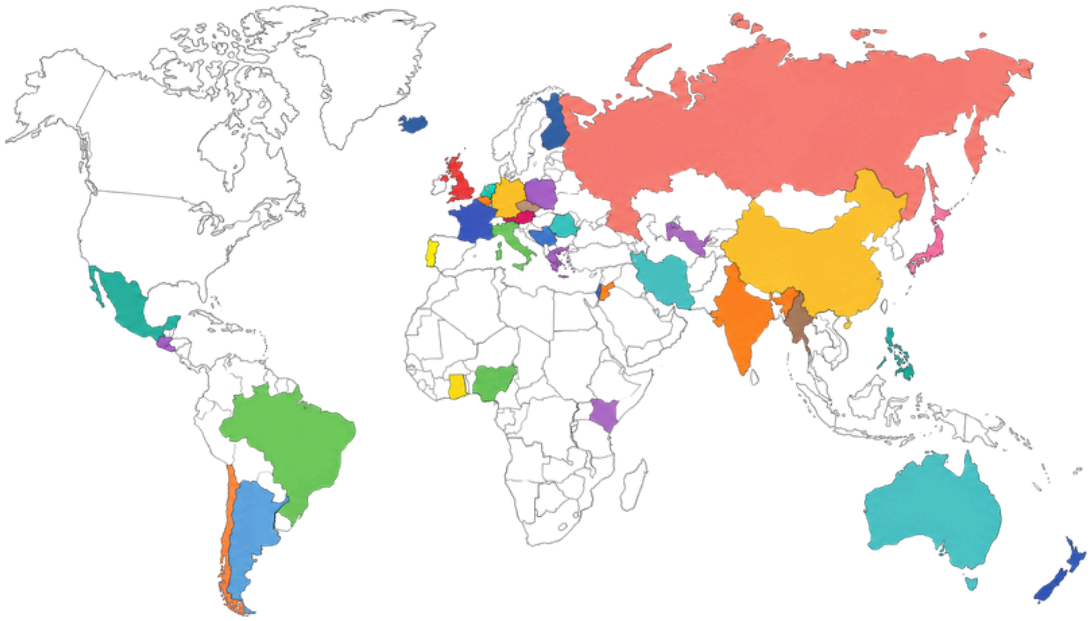
18
Countries Represented

Awards by Discipline by Country

COUNTRY	PHYSICS	CHEMISTRY	MEDICINE	ECONOMICS	LITERATURE	PEACE	TOTAL
United States	●●●●●●●●●●●●	●●●●	●●●●●●	●●●●●●●●●●●●	●	●●	37
United Kingdom	●●●		●●●				6
Japan	●	●●	●				4
Italy	●●						2
Sweden	●		●				2
Austria	●						1
Bangladesh						●	1
Canada			●				1
Colombia						●	1
Denmark			●				1
Finland				●			1
France					●		1
Germany			●				1
Greece					●		1
Israel		●					1
Netherlands				●			1
New Zealand		●					1
Norway				●			1

Fulbright at 80

Fulbright Pulitzer Prize Winners



94
Fulbright Pulitzer Winners

98
Pulitzer Prizes

35
Countries Represented

United Kingdom

Most common Fulbright destination among Pulitzer winners (**16 winners**).

Followed by the next most common Fulbright destinations:

- France (10)
- Italy (9)

Journalism

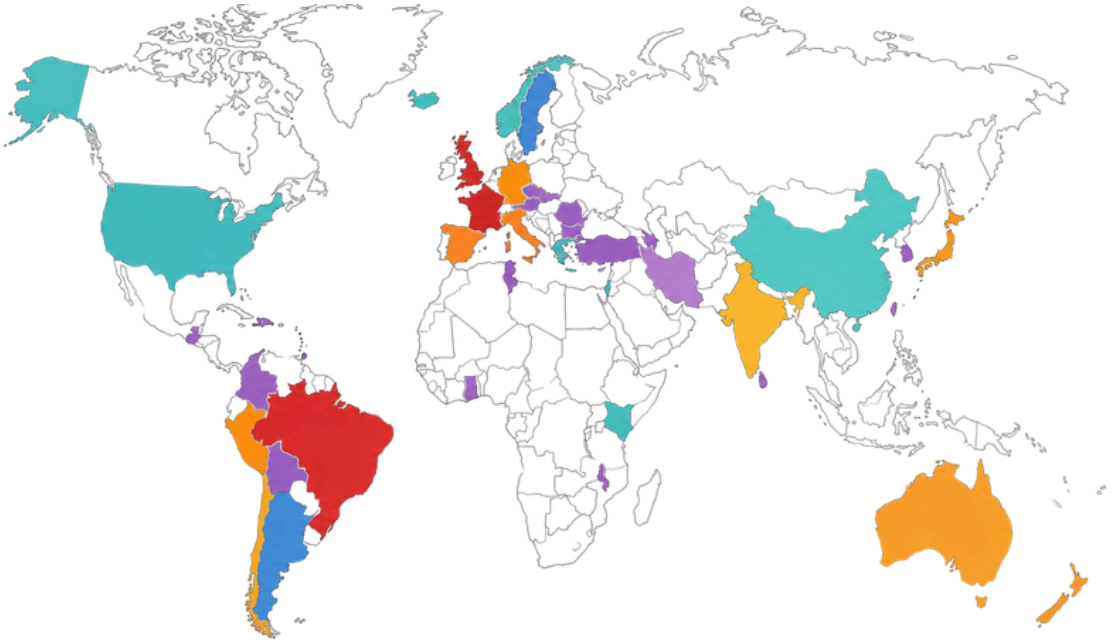
Most common Pulitzer field with **18 winners**.

Followed by the next most commonly represented fields:

- History (12)
- Poetry (11)
- Biography (10)
- Music (10)

Fulbright at 80

Fulbright MacArthur Genius Fellowships



83
MacArthur Genius Fellowships

40+
Countries Represented

Top Fulbright Host Countries:

United Kingdom (7)

Brazil (7)

France (7)

Italy (6)

Japan (4)

Most Commonly Represented Fields:

45.8% Arts & Humanities

26.5% Social Sciences

25.3% Science & Engineering

2.4% Public Leadership

Fulbright at 80

THANK YOU
TO OUR PARTNERS



United States Government
Bureau of Education and Cultural Affairs, United States Department of State (USDS)

American University Partners
- Adler University, Chicago
- American University
- Arizona State University
- Bridgewater State University
- The Citadel
- Clemson University
- Columbus State University
- Dartmouth College
- Florida Polytechnic University
- Iowa State University
- Ithaca College
- Johns Hopkins University
- Miami Dade College
- Ohio University
- San Diego State University
- Pierre Elliott Trudeau Foundation
- Smith College
- State University of New York College at Plattsburgh
- University of Arizona
- University of California at Irvine
- University of California, Santa Barbara
- University of Georgia
- University of Hawai'i at Mānoa
- University of Maine
- University of Memphis
- University of Southern California
- University of Texas at Austin
- University of Virginia
- University of Washington
- Vanderbilt University
- Wellesley College
- Yale University



Government of Canada
Global Affairs Canada (GAC)

Canadian University Partners
- Acadia University
- Balsillie School of International Affairs
- Brock University
- Carleton University
- Concordia University
- Dalhousie University
- King's University College
- Lakehead University
- McGill University
- McMaster University
- Memorial University of Newfoundland
- Mount Allison University
- Pierre Elliott Trudeau Foundation
- Queen's University
- Saint Mary's University
- Thompson Rivers University
- Trent University
- Université de Montréal
- Université du Québec en Outaouais
- Université Laval
- University Canada West
- University of Alberta
- University of British Columbia
- University of Calgary
- University of Guelph
- University of Manitoba
- University of New Brunswick
- University of Northern British Columbia
- University of Ottawa
- University of Prince Edward Island
- University of Regina
- University of Toronto
- University of Toronto, Scarborough
- University of Victoria
- University of Waterloo
- University of Windsor
- Vancouver Island University
- Western University
- York University
- Yukon University



Cooperating Agencies
- Institute of International Education (IIE)
- World Learning

Select Private Sector Partners
- Alacrity Canada
- Canadian Mountain Network
- CIBC
- Glen Corporation
- John R. Oshei Foundation
- Mitacs Globalink
- Pierre Elliott Trudeau Foundation
- RBC Foundation
- Samuel Centre for Social Connectedness (SCSC)
- The American Killam Trusts
- The Maple Leaf Foundation
- TD Bank
- World Learning

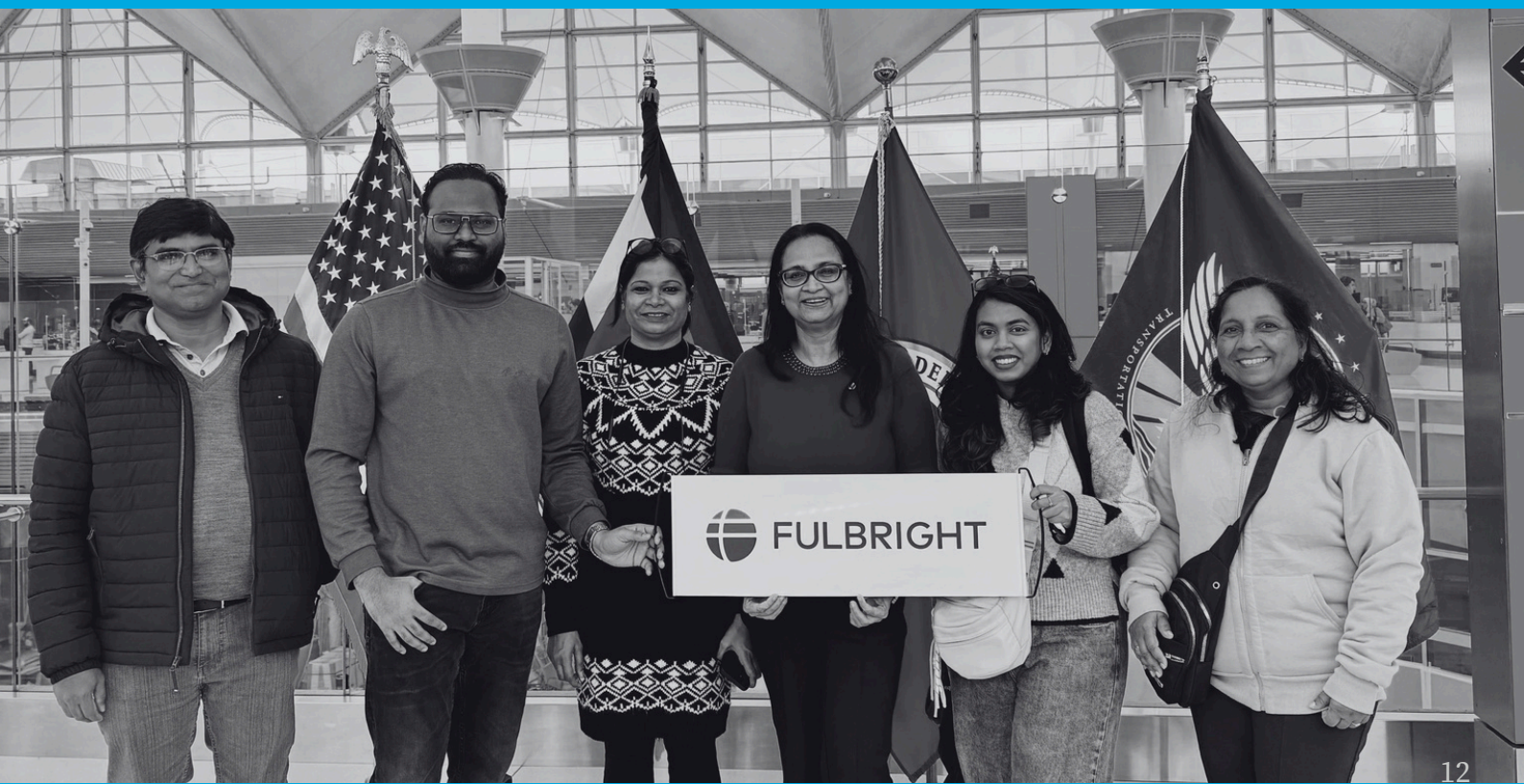
Fulbright at 80

LOOKING AHEAD

As Fulbright enters its ninth decade, its mission remains as relevant as ever: fostering mutual understanding, advancing knowledge, and building connections across borders.

AREAS SHAPING THE FUTURE

- **ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE & INNOVATION**
- **ENERGY SECURITY**
- **ENTREPRENEURSHIP**
- **PUBLIC HEALTH**
- **EDUCATION**
- **CULTURAL DIPLOMACY**



Fulbright at 80

SUPPORT THE LEGACY

Fulbright's strength has always come from its community. For 80 years, students, scholars, alumni, partners, donors, and volunteers have helped sustain a program that advances knowledge, understanding, and collaboration across borders.

MAKE A DONATION

Support the next generation of Fulbrighters by advancing educational exchange, research, and cross-border understanding.

Scan the QR Code to make a donation to Fulbright Canada.

JOIN THE ALUM NETWORK

Stay connected with fellow Fulbrighters through networking, mentorship, and events that foster lasting connections beyond the award experience.

Scan the QR Code to register at fulbrighternetwork.com.

SIGN UP FOR ALUM NEWS

Stay informed with the latest Fulbright news, events, opportunities, and alumni stories from across our global community.

Scan the QR Code to sign up for Fulbright Canada Alum News.

ADD TO THE TIME CAPSULE

Contribute reflections, photos, videos, and other artifacts to the Fulbright 2100 Time Capsule and help preserve the impact of Fulbright for future generations.

Scan the QR Code to contribute to the Fulbright 2100 Time Capsule.

WRITE YOUR LOCAL OFFICE

Champion international educational exchange by sharing the impact of Fulbright and helping raise awareness of its enduring value in your community.

GET INVOLVED WITH THE AAC

Support a vibrant Fulbright community by sharing your expertise, ideas, and perspectives with the Alum Advisory Committee to strengthen alumni engagement and connections across Canada—**email alumni@fulbright.ca to get involved.**



For 80 years, Fulbright has demonstrated the transformative power of international educational exchange.

Through scholarship, research, and cultural engagement, generations of Fulbrighters have crossed borders to learn, teach, discover, and collaborate.

Together, they have built lasting connections, advanced knowledge, strengthened communities, and fostered mutual understanding across cultures—helping to shape a more connected world.

The story continues.

Help Shape the Next 80 Years

Scan the QR code to support future Fulbright students and scholars.

www.fulbright.ca